

THE MORNING KICKOFF

🏆 FIFA World Cup 26 — United States · Canada · Mexico · Knockout stage — Round of 16



🏠 16 teams left — 8 by Tuesday night

👑 Golden Boot: three-way tie on 7 goals

🏆 Final: Sunday 19 July, MetLife Stadium

⚡ UPSET OF THE TOURNAMENT

GIANTS FALL IN NEW JERSEY

Erling Haaland struck twice in the last eleven minutes to send Brazil home and carry Norway into a World Cup quarter-final for the first time in the nation's history — on the very pitch where the final will be played two weeks from now.

ALSO THIS MORNING

- 🔗 FIFA reversed Folarin Balogun's red-card suspension on review — the striker can face Belgium tonight.
- 🚩 England sweat on two: Quansah is suspended for the quarter-final, and Jordan Henderson hurt an arm in the post-match celebrations.
- 📅 Last two round-of-16 ties tomorrow, rest day Wednesday — then the quarter-finals begin Thursday in Boston.

INSIDE TODAY'S EDITION

- P.2 Brazil 1–2 Norway — how the five-time champions were passed off their own party
- P.3 Mexico 2–3 England — lightning, Bellingham and ten-man defiance at the Azteca
- P.4 Tonight: the Iberian derby in Dallas, then the hosts face Belgium in Seattle
- P.5 NEW — The Crystal Ball: our calls for tonight's games, with the odds and the reasons
- P.6 Golden Boot: Mbappé, Messi & Haaland locked on 7 — a World Cup first
- P.7 The bracket, your week of football, and the road to MetLife



TONIGHT (CENTRAL EUROPE)

🇵🇹 Portugal — Spain

🇪🇸 21:00

🇺🇸 United States — Belgium

🇧🇪 02:00

FULL PREVIEWS
PAGE 4 →

⚡ UPSET

📍 New York New Jersey Stadium, East Rutherford



Brazil

1 – 2

FULL TIME

Norway



⚽ **Neymar** 90'+ · pen

⚽ **Haaland** 79' · header

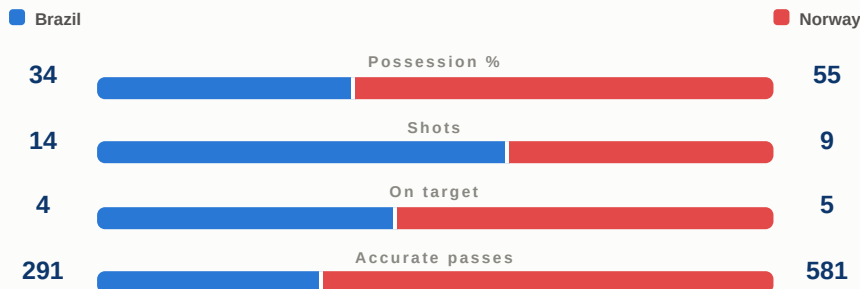
⚽ **Haaland** 90' · low drive

The stat sheet reads like a misprint: Brazil, the nation of jogo bonito, out-passed 581 to 291 in a knockout tie. Norway pressed high, moved the ball with total calm, and waited. On 79 minutes Haaland rose to head home a cross; in the 90th he collected the ball outside the box and arrowed a low drive past the goalkeeper. Brazil's 14 shots produced just four on target.

Neymar's stoppage-time penalty — his first goal of this World Cup — was no more than a farewell note. The five-time champions are out before the last eight, and a Norwegian side built on structure, running power and one unstoppable centre-forward marches on to Miami.

MATCH TIMELINE

● Norway above · ● Brazil below



★ STAR OF THE MATCH

Erling Haaland

A header and a 25-yard low drive in eleven minutes. Seven goals in five games — and next up, England in Saturday's Miami quarter-final.



Neymar, 34

His stoppage-time penalty — Brazil's only goal — may well be his final act at a World Cup.

⚡ Brazil's 34% possession — their lowest ever recorded in a World Cup match

🏆 Norway's first World Cup quarter-final in the nation's history

⚽ Haaland's brace takes him to 7 tournament goals — level with Mbappé and Messi

➔ **WHAT IT MEANS** Norway meet England in Saturday's Miami quarter-final (23:00). Brazil go home earlier than at any World Cup in a generation.

⚡ CLASSIC

📍 Estadio Azteca, Mexico City · Att. 80,824



Mexico

2 – 3

FULL TIME

England



- ⚽ Quiñones 42' · header from a corner
- ⚽ Jiménez 69' · pen

- ⚽ Bellingham 36', 38' · brace in 90 seconds
- ⚽ Kane 60' · pen

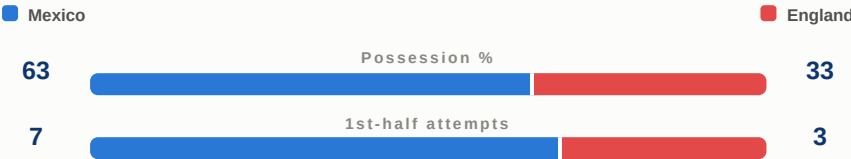
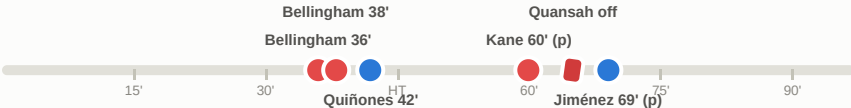
🟡 Red card: Quansah (ENG), 2nd half — England finished the game with ten men

An hour late after lightning storms, and worth every minute of the wait. Bellingham scored twice in the space of 90 seconds to silence 80,824 at the Azteca; Quiñones headed one back from a corner before the break. When Rangel brought down Gordon, Kane converted the 60th-minute penalty — then the match turned: Quansah saw red, VAR gave Mexico a penalty of their own, and Jiménez buried it.

The last twenty minutes were a siege. England made 49 clearances — their most at a World Cup since 1990 — and finished with 33% of the ball, their lowest on record. It didn't matter. Mexico's proud unbeaten home World Cup record ends on the ground where it was built, and England march on with what ESPN called the best away win in their history.

MATCH TIMELINE

● England above · ● Mexico below



★ STAR OF THE MATCH · RATED 9.2

Jude Bellingham

Two goals in 90 seconds — the first man to score twice at the Azteca in a World Cup match since Diego Maradona in 1986.



Harry Kane

Ice-cold from the spot in front of a hostile wall of noise. Five tournament goals — two behind the leaders.

⚡ Kick-off delayed an hour by lightning storms over Mexico City

⚽ England's 33% possession — their lowest at a World Cup since records began in 1966

🛡️ 49 England clearances, their most in a World Cup game since 1990

➔ WHAT IT MEANS England face Haaland's Norway in Miami on Saturday night — a heavyweight quarter-final between the tournament's form sides.

THE IBERIAN DERBY



Portugal

VS

Spain



21:00
 22:00
 00:30 +1
 15:00
 13:00

Kick-off 3:00 PM ET at the stadium

AT&T Stadium, Dallas

Neighbours, rivals, and two of the tournament's best attacks meet far from home. Spain have looked the more controlled side, patient and suffocating in possession; Portugal have been ruthless in transition, scoring in bursts. European champions against Iberian pride — knockout football rarely gifts a derby this big, this early.

- 👁 The midfield duel: Spain's control against Portugal's counter-punch
- 👁 Winner faces the USA or Belgium in Friday's Los Angeles quarter-final



KEY MAN · SPAIN

Mikel Oyarzabal

Four goals this tournament, quietly among the Golden Boot chasers — and Spain's most reliable big-game finisher.

HOSTS UNDER THE LIGHTS



United States

VS

Belgium



02:00 +1
 03:00 +1
 05:30 +1
 20:00
 18:00

Kick-off 8:00 PM ET at the stadium

Lumen Field, Seattle

The co-hosts ride a wave of home support into one of America's loudest stadiums — with a boost from the committee room: FIFA reversed Folarin Balogun's red-card suspension on review, freeing the striker to lead the line. Belgium's post-golden-generation side is dangerous but beatable, and Seattle will believe.

- 👁 Balogun, reprieved, against a reshuffled Belgian back line
- 👁 A first USMNT quarter-final since 2002 is 90 minutes away



KEY MAN · UNITED STATES

Folarin Balogun

Suspension overturned, point to prove. The Seattle crowd will make him the story of the night if he scores.

EARLIER IN THE ROUND OF 16

The weekend results

Morocco 3 – 0 **Canada**

Sat 4 July

France 1 – 0 **Paraguay**

Sat 4 July

TOMORROW — THE LAST-EIGHT DECIDERS



Argentina – Egypt



18:00



Switzerland – Colombia



22:00

Portugal v Spain

★ OUR CALL: SPAIN 2–1

RESULT AFTER 90 MINUTES



TO REACH THE QUARTER-FINAL



FORM

Spain are unbeaten and have not conceded a goal all tournament; Portugal needed a stoppage-time winner to squeeze past Croatia in the last 32.



HEAD-TO-HEAD

Portugal beat Spain on penalties in last summer's Nations League final after a 2–2 draw. These sides know each other perfectly.



FITNESS & FATIGUE

Portugal report a fully fit squad. Spain are likely without wingers Nico Williams and Yeremy Pino, who both missed the Austria game.



WHERE THE MONEY IS

Bookmakers price Spain around 52% to win in 90 minutes, the draw 27%, Portugal 25% — and prediction markets agree almost exactly.



THE VERDICT Spain's control against Ronaldo's ruthlessness. The statistics say Spain; recent history says never count Portugal out. We take Spain narrowly — with a real chance this one goes the distance.

United States v Belgium

★ OUR CALL: USA 2–1

RESULT AFTER 90 MINUTES



TO REACH THE QUARTER-FINAL



FORM

The hosts have impressed since a 4–1 opening win over Paraguay; Belgium have looked flat and leggy since crossing the Atlantic.



HEAD-TO-HEAD

Belgium won the famous 2014 round-of-16 meeting 2–1 in extra time — the Tim Howard game. Twelve years on, the roles are reversed.



FITNESS & FATIGUE

Balogun (3 goals) is back after FIFA overturned his red card. McKenzie and Roldan are being assessed; Zeno Debast remains doubtful for Belgium.



WHERE THE MONEY IS

The market makes the USA clear favourites — around –190 against +175 for Belgium — and Balogun's reinstatement shortened those odds further.



THE VERDICT Home crowd, fresher legs and the leading scorer back in the side: everything points to the USA, provided they survive the moments of Belgian magic. A first quarter-final since 2002, says the crystal ball.

The Crystal Ball is for family bragging rights only. Probabilities blend public bookmaker odds with our own reading of form, fitness and history. Entertainment — not financial or betting advice.



Kylian Mbappé

2 assists — holds the tie-breaker

7



Lionel Messi

Plays Egypt tomorrow — a chance to pull clear

7



Erling Haaland

Brace against Brazil — the man in form

7

1 **Kylian Mbappé**
France · 2 assists

2 **Lionel Messi**
Argentina

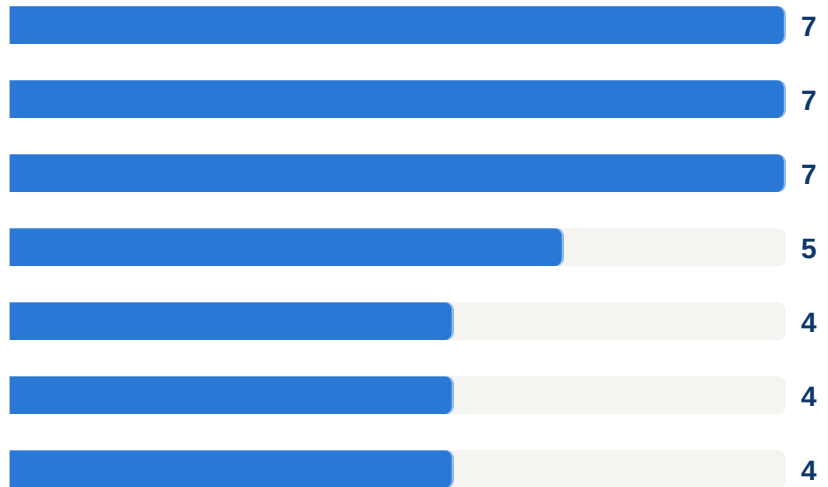
3 **Erling Haaland**
Norway · brace vs Brazil

4 **Harry Kane**
England

5 **Vinícius Júnior**
Brazil · eliminated

6 **Mikel Oyarzabal**
Spain · plays today

7 **Ousmane Dembélé**
France



Tie-break: assists, then minutes played. Mbappé leads on 2 assists.

NUMBERS OF THE DAY

7-7-7

Mbappé, Messi & Haaland — first World Cup ever with three players on 7+ goals

1st

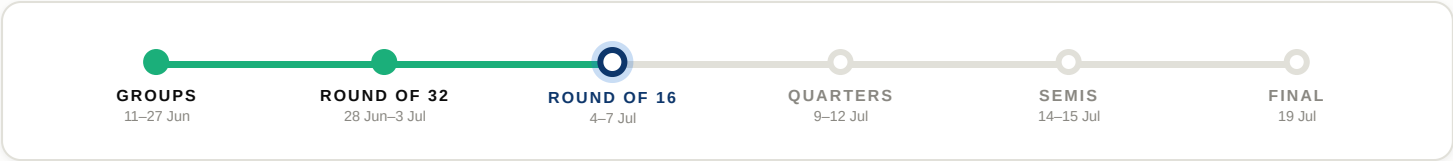
Quarter-final in Norway's history — Brazil out before the last eight

80,824

At the Azteca to see Mexico's first home World Cup defeat

33%

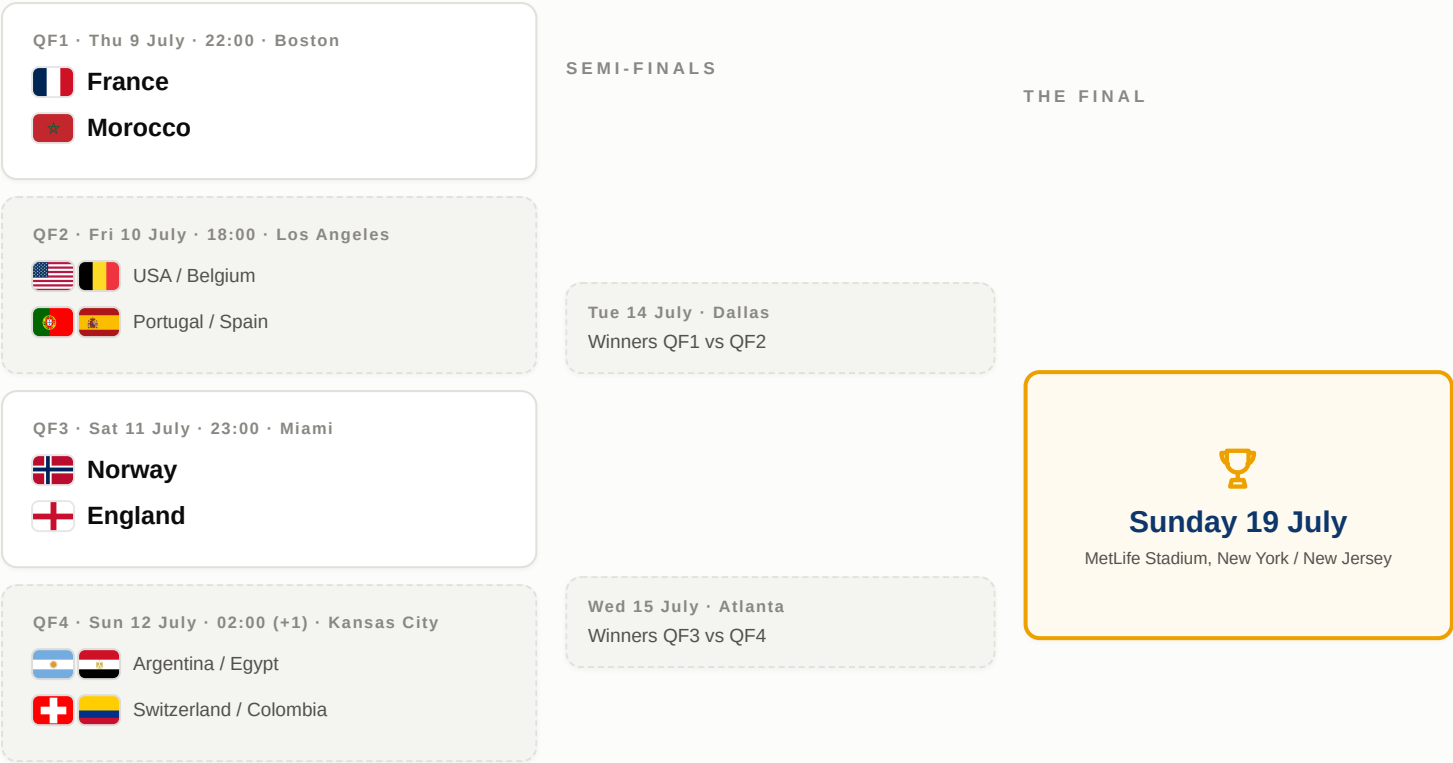
England's possession — their lowest at a World Cup since 1966



KNOCKOUT BRACKET

Quarter-finals 9–12 July · Semi-finals 14–15 July

QUARTER-FINALS



YOUR WEEK IN FOOTBALL

Monday 6 — Sunday 12 July

MON 6 Jul Portugal–Spain · 21:00 USA–Belgium · 02:00	TUE 7 Jul Argentina–Egypt · 18:00 Switzerland–Colombia · 22:00	WED 8 Jul Rest day — last 8 set	THU 9 Jul QF1 France–Morocco · 22:00	FRI 10 Jul QF2 in Los Angeles · 18:00	SAT 11 Jul QF3 Norway–England · 23:00	SUN 12 Jul QF4 in Kansas City · 02:00 (+1)
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See you tomorrow morning.

Next edition: the last two quarter-finalists — Argentina–Egypt and Switzerland–Colombia reports, plus the full last-eight preview.

Player photos: Bryan Berlin (CC BY-SA 4.0), Rolandhino1 (CC BY-SA 4.0), via Wikimedia Commons.